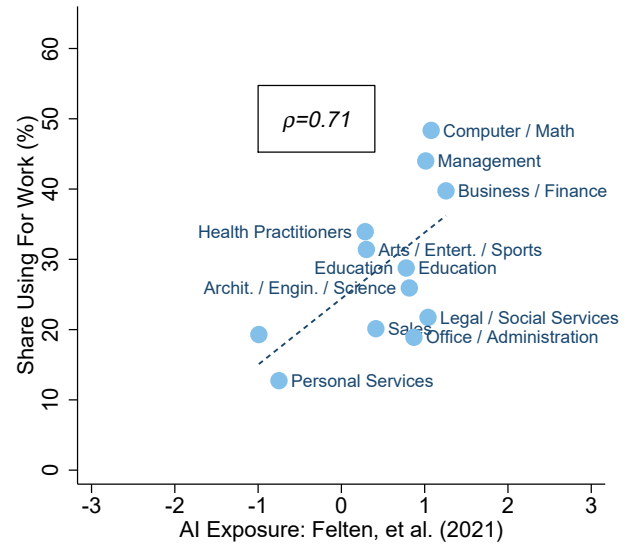
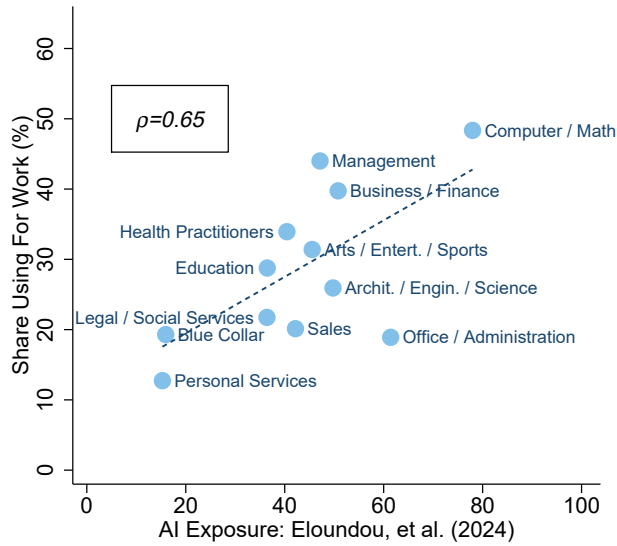


Figure 6: Accounting for Variation in Generative AI Adoption At Work By Occupation

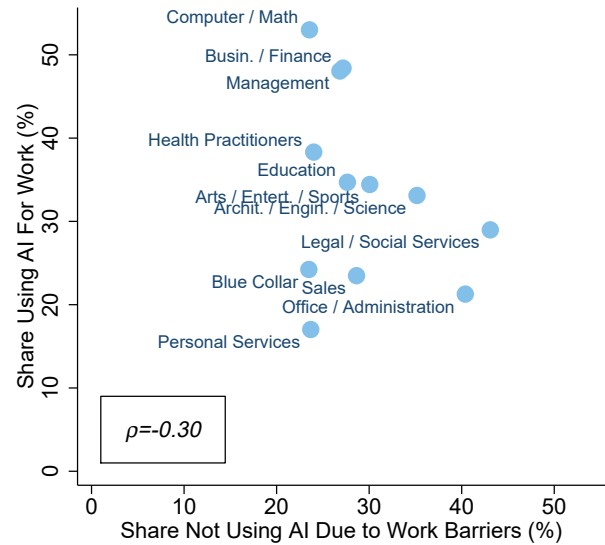
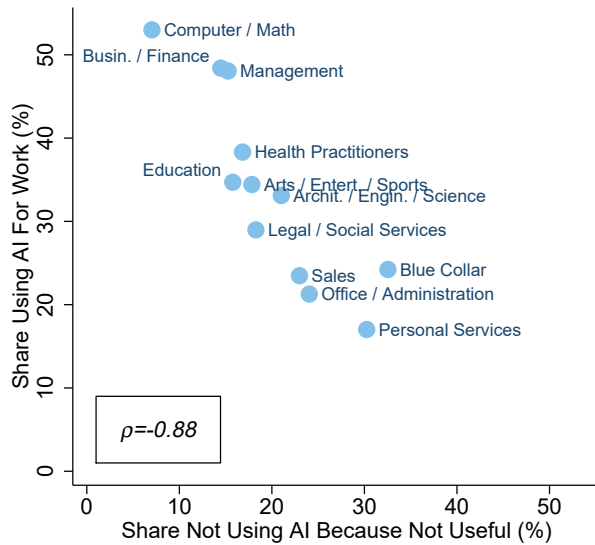
(a) Predicted Exposure: Eloundou et al. (2024)

(b) Predicted Exposure: Felten et al. (2021)



(c) Share Stating AI Not Useful

(d) Share Stating AI Barriers at Work



Notes: Panel (a) scatters occupational genAI adoption rates at work against predicted genAI exposure (ChatGPT- β) from Eloundou et al. (2024). Panel (b) scatters occupational genAI adoption rates at work against predicted genAI exposure from Felten et al. (2021). Panel (c) scatters occupational genAI adoption rates at work against the share of all workers in that occupation who reported that they did not use genAI because it was not useful for their job. Panel (d) scatters occupational genAI adoption rates at work against the share of all workers in that occupation who reported that they did not use genAI due to barriers at work. The data source for genAI use and reasons for non-use is the November 2024 RPS. The sample for the RPS is employed individuals age 18-64 ($N = 3671$). We exclude workers in “agriculture / forestry / fishing” due to a very low sample size.

These results are consistent with the notion that existing task-based exposure predictions may not perfectly identify which occupations would benefit from genAI. For example, while managers have similar predicted exposure than administrative occupations, many more administrative workers report that genAI is not useful for their job. Collectively, our takeaway is that existing task-based exposure measures are informative but incomplete: while they do capture broad patterns in genAI adoption, more work is needed to accurately identify which jobs would benefit from genAI.

Another potential reason that task-based exposure predictions may not perfectly predict adoption is that some jobs may face various barriers to adoption. In our question about why workers did not adopt genAI, a second set of explanations relates to adoption barriers: “My employer does not allow me to use genAI; I am unsure whether my employer allows me to use genAI; I feel pressure from coworkers to not use genAI; I have privacy or security concerns; I am unsure how to use genAI for my job.” We define the share of an occupation who does not use genAI because of adoption barriers as the share of all workers in that occupation who ranked at least one of these options in their top two reasons for not using genAI.

Figure 6d plots genAI adoption against the share who reported that they faced adoption barriers. This correlation (-0.30) is lower than in the previous figure, indicating that variation in adoption barriers only accounts for a small share of the overall variation in adoption. At the same time, two occupations stand out in terms of a high share of workers facing adoption barriers: legal / social services and office / administrative workers. Workers in these occupations may be especially likely to deal with sensitive information that makes employers reluctant to allow genAI use, or leads workers to self-regulate in the absence of formal policies. These findings suggest that managers can play a role in genAI adoption by setting clear usage guidelines and helping employees navigate privacy and security issues.

In addition to minimizing barriers to genAI adoption, we also find evidence that firms and managers can increase genAI adoption through active encouragement. The RPS asked workers “Does your employer encourage you to use Generative AI for your job?”. Employer encouragement is highly correlated with adoption: 86% of respondents whose employer encourages genAI use report adopting it, compared to just 13% among those whose employer does not.

We conclude this section by jointly analyzing the role of demographics, occupation, and employer encouragement. Table 1 presents results from a linear regression of an indicator for genAI use last week on these variables. Demographic controls (sex, age, and education) alone account for 8% of the variation in adoption. Adding controls for occupation group and predicted exposure by occupation (Eloundou et al., 2024) increases this share to 12%. Occupation controls decrease the magnitude of most demographic coefficients, and in particular reduce the coefficients on Bachelor’s Degree and Graduate Degree by roughly one third. Finally,

Table 1: Predictors of Generative AI Use at Work Last Week

	(1)	(2)	(3)
Constant	0.266*** (0.018)	0.213*** (0.052)	0.066 (0.042)
Female	-0.070*** (0.014)	-0.048*** (0.015)	-0.018* (0.011)
Age: 18-29	-0.016 (0.022)	-0.014 (0.021)	-0.028* (0.016)
Age: 40-49	-0.015 (0.021)	-0.028 (0.021)	0.009 (0.016)
Age: 50-64	-0.152*** (0.019)	-0.157*** (0.019)	-0.059*** (0.014)
Education: Bachelor's Degree	0.189*** (0.017)	0.123*** (0.018)	0.032** (0.014)
Education: Graduate Degree	0.243*** (0.022)	0.157*** (0.024)	0.034* (0.018)
Predicted Exposure (Eloundou et al.)	—	0.206*** (0.065)	0.092* (0.051)
Employer Encourages AI Use	—	—	0.652*** (0.016)
Occupation Controls		Y	Y
R ² -adj	0.07	0.12	0.50
N	6883	6883	6883

Notes: Dependent variable is an indicator for whether the respondent used genAI at work in the previous week. Standard errors are in parentheses. *, **, *** indicate significance at the 10, 5, and 1 percent levels, respectively. Data source is the August and November 2024 waves of the RPS, ages 18-64. The sample for this table is employed individuals. We exclude workers in “agriculture / forestry / fishing” due to a very low sample size.

adding an indicator for employer encouragement dramatically raises the share of variation explained to 50%. The coefficient on employer encouragement indicates that, holding other variables constant, a worker is 65 percentage points more likely to use genAI for work if their employer encourages them to do so. Controlling for employer encouragement also reduces the magnitude of coefficients on demographic and occupation controls relative to the previous specification. We caution that the estimated effect of employer encouragement is not necessarily causal as it may be highly correlated with a worker’s roles and responsibilities (though this is partially addressed through occupation controls).

The findings in this section support two conclusions. First, job tasks and responsibilities appear to be a primary determinant of genAI adoption patterns. Second, workplace barriers and encouragement also play an important role in a worker’s adoption decision. Hence, when job tasks are amenable to genAI adoption, firms can play an active role by promoting usage, offering training, and removing organizational barriers to adoption.

Figure 7: In Which Specific Work Tasks Is Generative AI Most Useful?



Notes: The figure shows which work tasks genAI users report that genAI is most helpful in completing. Employed respondents who used genAI were first provided with a list of tasks and asked to select those that they had used genAI to help with last week. Respondents were then asked to rank these selected tasks according to how helpful genAI was in completing the task. The figure reports the share of genAI users who ranked a particular task either #1 (AI was most helpful in this task) or #2. The bars do not have a natural sum because some respondents selected fewer than two tasks. Data source is employed respondents ages 18-64 who used genAI for work and selected at least one task in the August and November 2024 waves of the RPS.

4.2 Generative AI Use Across Specific Tasks

Given the high correlation between job tasks and adoption, a natural follow up question is to ask which tasks genAI helps workers complete. We present genAI users with the list of tasks in Figure 7 and ask them to select any for which they had used genAI in the last week. (They were also allowed to write in other tasks.) Respondents were then asked to rank these tasks according to how helpful genAI was in completing them.

Figure 7 reports the share of respondents who ranked each task in the top two in terms of importance. The highest ranked tasks at work were writing (45.1%), administrative tasks (29.9%), and interpreting/translating/summarizing text or data (25.9%). These findings mirror recent experimental evidence on how genAI reshapes work behavior. Dillon et al. (2025) show that workers with access to integrated generative AI tools (Microsoft 365 Copilot) spent less time on email and completed written documents more quickly. At the same time, while genAI seems most useful for creating, absorbing, and organizing written information, eight of the ten tasks in our list were ranked by at least 10% of users, indicating a variety of use cases for genAI.

5 How Large Are Potential Productivity Gains from GenAI?

New technologies raise productivity by enabling complementary innovations in processes, skills, and organizational practices. These innovations typically evolve gradually over time (Brynjolf-